

MNRAS Submission Instructions

“A morphological barrier: quantifying the injection realism gap for CNN strong lens finders in DESI Legacy Survey DR10”

Balaji & Johnson (2026)

Files in the repository

File	GitHub Link	Purpose
Manuscript PDF (submission)	balaji_johnson_2026_mnras.pdf	Upload this to ScholarOne
Manuscript TEX	balaji_johnson_2026_mnras.tex	LaTeX source
Cover letter PDF	cover_letter.pdf	Reference for cover letter text
Submission zip	mnras_submission.zip	Send to MNRAS after
(post-acceptance only)		acceptance
Full repository	stronglens-realism-gap	

Note: `mnras_merged_draft.tex` and `mnras_merged_draft.pdf` are identical working copies kept alongside the submission-named versions.

ScholarOne submission portal

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Log in → **Author Centre** → **Submit a Manuscript**

Step 1 — Manuscript type, title, abstract

- **Manuscript type:** Main Journal
- **Title:** A morphological barrier: quantifying the injection realism gap for CNN strong lens finders in DESI Legacy Survey DR10
- **Running head:** Injection realism gap for CNN lens finding
- **Abstract:** Paste the four-paragraph block from the paper beginning “*Calibrating the selection function of CNN strong lens finders...*”

Step 2 — Upload files

Upload **one file only** — the compiled PDF:

File	Designation to select in ScholarOne
<code>balaji_johnson_2026_mnras.pdf</code>	Complete manuscript file (PDF, PS or DOC)

Do **not** upload the zip. Do **not** upload figures separately. The PDF already contains all figures and tables. Click **Upload Files** at the bottom of the screen before proceeding.

If ScholarOne rejects the PDF: add `\pdfminorversion=5` as the very first line of `balaji_johnson_2026_mnras.tex`, recompile, and upload the new PDF.

Step 3 — Keywords

Select these five from the MNRAS keyword list (1–6 required):

1. gravitational lensing: strong
 2. methods: data analysis
 3. methods: statistical
 4. surveys
 5. techniques: image processing
-

Step 4 — Authors

Add in this exact order using the **Find** button to search for existing accounts:

#	Name	Institution	Role
1	Aditrivaishnavi Balaji	BASIS Independent Silicon Valley, 1290 Parkmoor Ave, San Jose, California	Corresponding author / Contact author
2	Parker T. Johnson	Steward Observatory, The University of Arizona, 933 North Cherry Avenue, Tucson, Arizona	Co-author

Step 5 — Preferred/non-preferred reviewers

Leave both fields **blank**. The cover letter already states no preference.

Step 6 — Cover letter

Paste the following text directly into the cover letter text box. Do **not** attach a file.

Dear Editor,

We submit the enclosed manuscript, “A morphological barrier: quantifying the injection realism gap for CNN strong lens finders in DESI Legacy Survey DR10,” for consideration as a Paper in MNRAS.

This manuscript has not been published previously and is not under consideration by any other journal. All authors have read the final version and approved its submission.

AI tool disclosure. Per MNRAS policy, we note that AI language models (Claude, Anthropic; ChatGPT, OpenAI) were used as coding assistants during the development of analysis scripts and for manuscript copy-editing. All AI-assisted code was reviewed, tested, and verified by the authors, who are solely responsible for the scientific content of this paper.

We have no preferred or non-preferred editors or reviewers.

The authors declare no conflicts of interest.

Yours sincerely, Aditri Vaishnavi Balaji Parker T. Johnson

Step 7 — Review proof PDF and submit

ScholarOne generates a combined PDF for review. Check every item before clicking Submit:

- ☐ Title and running head correct on page 1
- ☐ Both authors and affiliations present
- ☐ Abstract complete (4 paragraphs)
- ☐ Preprint date shows 25 May 2026
- ☐ All 5 figures present (Figures 1–5)
- ☐ All tables present (Tables 1–9, Table B1 in appendix)
- ☐ References section complete and alphabetical
- ☐ No missing or scrambled pages
- ☐ Page numbering continuous throughout

Once all boxes checked, click **Submit**.

After submission

Item	Detail
Manuscript ID	Emailed immediately — save it
Editorial acknowledgement	Within a few days
Typical review time	4–8 weeks
APC	£2,310 (~\$2,900–3,000 USD), invoiced after acceptance only — nothing to pay now
Source files	Requested after acceptance — send <code>mnras_submission.zip</code> at that stage